

What Kind of E-mail is There?

There are primarily two types of e-mail systems in use: POP mail and Web mail. In the former, mail is stored on a server that runs a special mail-handling protocol called Post Office Protocol (POP); its most recent version is POP3. This lets the server receive mail and hold on to it until it is accessed by your e-mail client. POP can basically be thought of as a 'store and forward' system for your e-mail. Internet service providers (ISPs) such as VSNL, RoltaNet, Satyam, etc, provide this service, where you can access e-mail using this system if you are registered with them.

The second type of e-mail system used is Web mail. Here, you do not need an e-mail client—you can access your e-mail directly on the Internet by logging onto the Web site that runs this service. A popular example of this would be Yahoo! Mail or Hotmail. These Web sites are free e-mail service providers where, once you register with them, you can access your mail from anywhere in the world—all you need is access to the Internet, be it through a computer, an Internet Kiosk, a set-top box or even a handheld device.

of contacts (Friends, Family, etc). Do this by following the same steps above, but instead of New, choose New Group. This will open a box where you can choose the contacts you need to add to a particular group. After you're through with adding contacts, give the group a name and click on OK. From now on, you can send a mail to all the people in the group in one shot by simply typing out the group name in the 'To:' field.

Deleting entries: If you need to delete entries from your Address Book, simply open the Address Book, select the contact you need to remove and hit [Delete]. After confirming the deletion, the contact will be permanently removed from your Address Book.

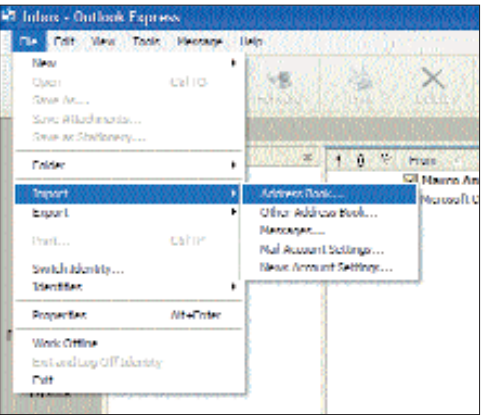
TRICK 5. Dealing with Spam

Spam is the term given to unwanted mail that we receive in the form of newsletters, offers, advertisements, press releases, etc.

The best way to battle spam is to unsubscribe from the mail that you're continually receiving and if that doesn't work you should delete them. The most effective and automated way to do this is to use the Message Rules feature of Outlook Express as described earlier. Simply set up a rule that deletes all mail that arrives from a particular address, or with certain words in the subject line or the message body.

TRICK 6. Importing and Exporting messages and settings

Once your mail client is up and running, you might want to back up your e-mail or addresses or you might wish to port your settings over to another e-mail client or move it to a different computer.



You can import a variety of OE components

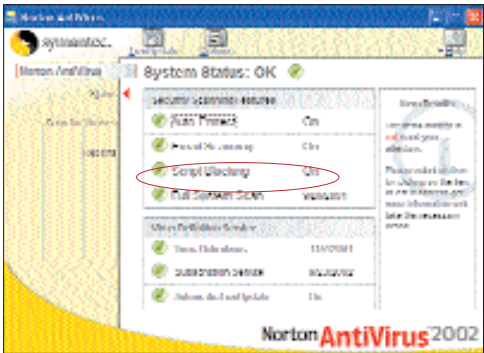
Outlook Express has an Import/Export feature that helps you do just this. If you need to import settings, click on File > Import from the main window. Here, you will be presented with a list of tasks that you can do (import another address book or mail message or mail settings). Choose the correct source from where the

import needs to take place in each of these cases and follow the steps.

Similarly, you can transfer (export) messages or your address book to a different computer or for backup. Click on File > Export from the main window and choose to either export your address book or mail messages.

TRICK 7. Keeping your mailbox virus-free

E-mail messages are one of the prime means through which viruses infect a system. Many anti-virus programs from companies such as Norton and McAfee feature specific plugins that monitor the e-mail sent and received and verify that they are virus-free. After loading these programs, a specific icon gets created through which you can change settings as to what files are scanned during the course of your work.



Protection for your e-mail

As a rule of thumb, do not open any attachments that are sent to you, unless you are certain that they are legitimate and from a trusted source. This especially holds true for executable (.EXE, .COM) and batch files (.BAT) files. If you are uncertain, delete the e-mail immediately and notify the person who sent it.

TRICK 8. Ready-at-hand tools

You can customise the Outlook Express toolbar so that it shows the commands you use often, such as Print or Find. Right-click the toolbar, and then click Buttons. Select the buttons you want to add on the left, and then click Add. If you want to remove a button, select it on the right, and then click Remove.

You can even rearrange the toolbar buttons by selecting one on the right, and then clicking the Move Up or Move Down button.

TRICK 9. Working offline

Reading newsgroups offline: You don't have to stay connected to the Net while you read all the messages contained in the newsgroups you subscribe to. Save up on the phone bill by downloading the newsgroup messages and then read them offline. You can choose to download only specific messages by first downloading only the